

The Lingua Handbook

Everything Lingua, from start to finish

DESIGN · PRODUCT · PEOPLE · LAUNCH · RUNNING IT

Second edition, October 2026

Learn a language
by living in it.

LINGUA

This book is for whoever works on Lingua next: you, a friend, or a Claude on another account. It says what Lingua is like, what it does, who it is for, how to tell people about it and how to run it, so that every page and every step can become a little more like it.

It lives in the repository at `docs/handbook`. Print it, scribble in it, and change it when Lingua changes.

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

How to use this book

Read Part One once. It is short, and everything else follows from it.

When you sit down to design a page, open its chapter in Part Four. Every room fits on one page: what the room is for, what it shows first, what it keeps quiet, the one thing to do there, and three questions to ask yourself.

The exact things live in the margins. Colours, sizes, file names, springs and dates are written small, beside the sentence they belong to. You can read the book without them, and you can build from them without reading the book.

LIKE THIS

The exact things live out here, small, beside the sentence they belong to.

Before you call a page done, go through Part Five. Its review sheet is meant to be printed and ticked, one sheet per page.

Parts Two and Six to Nine are the rest of the work: what Lingua does and where it is going, who it is for, telling people, running it, and the whole road from here to version 1.0.

At the back are every number in one place, the Latin names and what they mean, Lingua 7 at a glance, and a page for your own notes.

A few marks

in the margin	the fine print: exact values and where they live
~~*struck through*~~	something Lingua had and took out, kept so we remember why
☐	something to check
	a pause

THE WHOLE BOOK

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PART ONE

The spirit

What Lingua is, how it behaves, and how it talks.



CHAPTER 1

What Lingua is

Lingua is a place to live in a language for a while. You read in it, listen to it, watch it, talk and write in it, and every word you meet is kept, so it comes back just before you would have forgotten it.

THE TOKENS

`src/design/tokens.css`, "Cozy Scriptorium design tokens".

It is not a game and it is not a school. It is closer to a study at home: a desk by the window, a shelf of books, a pot of tea going cold because the chapter got good. That is why its design is called the Cozy Scriptorium.

ORDER

`src/app/sections.ts`. Alt 1 to 8 opens them in this order. Ratio and Settings sit apart at the bottom of the sidebar.

The rooms have Latin names, because a scriptorium would have used them, and because it is a little bit fun. Each room keeps one kind of work:

Home	your hearth: today, and what's next
Cursus	the course, grammar, alphabets and typing
Codex	reading: books, articles, comics
Thesaurus	every word you keep, and Ludus, the games
Sonus et Visio	listening and watching
Mentis	the guide, talking and writing
Ratio	how it's going
Settings	everything you can change

DESKTOP ONLY

Since 2026-10-20. The user: "Phone is not needed anymore." What exists for the phone stays; nothing new is made for it.

Lingua is made for the desktop. It uses a wide window the way you use a desk: things side by side, nothing stacked that could sit next to each other.

CHAPTER 2

Six habits of a Lingua page

Six habits, more than rules. A page that has all six usually needs nothing else.

I. The language comes first

On every page, the language is the biggest, best-set thing there is. A sentence in German gets the serif, the space and the light; the buttons around it step back. If a page has nothing in the language on it, ask whether it should.

SET IN

Titles in Literata. Reading text in the learner's own reading font, one of six.

II. Quiet until asked

Show the one thing that matters and keep the rest a click away: details in a drawer, numbers on hover, options under More. Control is never taken away, only folded. Whoever wants every setting finds it; whoever doesn't never has to see it.

BUT

Nothing important lives only on hover. Whatever a hover shows, a click or a key shows too.

III. One word, everywhere

A word saved while reading is the same word in Thesaurus, in Ludus, in a talk in Sermo and in Ratio's counts. Design as if each word were a small thing the learner carries from room to room, and let it remember where it was found.

WHERE WORDS LIVE

The word memory and the dictionary, Thesaurus › Dictionary (4.0-2).



IV. Honest, never hopeful

TAKEN OUT

2026-10-26: the first start's "B1 in about 7 months" and its pace verdicts. Not accurate enough to say.

Say only what is true and built. No forecasts Lingua can't keep, no scores that look precise and aren't, no features promised before they exist. When Lingua doesn't know, it says so plainly, or says nothing at all.

V. The learner holds the pen

BORROWED

From the Lingyu blueprint (2026-10-25): "saving is not scheduling"; anything generated is editable and can be dismissed.

Whatever Lingua decides for you can be undone: a word marked known can be unmarked, a level changed, a card edited. Nothing large happens behind the learner's back. Saving a word is not the same as scheduling it, and one click never quietly grows a deck of fifty.

VI. Wide and calm

SIZES

Check at 1280, 1440 and 1366 × 768. Shortcuts: Alt 1–8 for the rooms; the rest in the Shortcuts dialog.

Use the width: columns, side panels, sticky rails, a list beside its detail instead of a page after it. Every page fits a 1366 × 768 laptop with no little scroll bar sneaking in. The reader and long lists are the only things that scroll, and they do it on purpose.

If you only remember one: the language first, everything else quiet.



CHAPTER 3

The voice

Lingua talks like a friend who reads a lot: informal, warm, a little dry. It likes to make you smile, but never at the cost of being clear.

One smile per page. A funny subtitle is a gift; three of them are a stand-up set. The joke goes where nobody has to read it to act: a subtitle, a quiet line under a field. Never inside an instruction.

Titles ask or name. "What language will it be?" "So, how far along are you?" "Choose your study light." Short enough to take in at a glance, and a real question when there is one.

Buttons say what happens. "Continue with Deutsch" says more than "Next". One main button per page.

Plain where it matters. Money, privacy, errors and deleting get the plainest words in the app. "Could not save your choices. Please try again."

Small manners. British spelling, as in colour and favourite. Curly quotes, and the language's own quotation marks when its touches are on. No exclamation marks in the interface; the welcome toast may keep its one.



THE USER'S OUTLINE

For the first start: "minimal, informal, bookish, building up the excitement, with funny subtitles" (5.1–2b).

REAL LINES

From `Onboarding.tsx`: the error above, and the welcome toast, "Welcome to Lingua, {name}. Happy reading!"

MARKS

« French » · „German“ · 「Japanese」

Said, and rather not

Lingua's own lines on the left. The struck-through ones were in Lingua and were taken out.

WE SAY	WE'D RATHER NOT
What language will it be?	Select your target language
Continue with Deutsch	Next
8 of 15 minutes	53% of your daily goal complete!
It stays on this device. We just like to be polite.	We value your privacy.
Click a country to see what's spoken there, or scroll down for all of them.	~~… Commitment issues welcome. you can add more later.~~ A joke inside an instruction.
(nothing, when Lingua can't know)	~~At 15 minutes a day, B1 in about 7 months.~~ A forecast it couldn't keep.
Your shelf is empty. Import a book, or take one from the library.	No items found.
None of Lingua's languages is spoken in {country} yet.	No results.

FOR EXAMPLE

"Your shelf is empty …" is an example of the voice, not a line in the app.

Read your page aloud in the voice of someone who likes you. If a sentence would sound strange said to a friend across a table, change it.



PART TWO

The product

What Lingua does today, in which languages, for what price, and where it is going.



CHAPTER 4

What Lingua does today

SOURCE

`docs/FEATURES.md`, kept up to date with every step.

Room by room, what a learner can do in Lingua now (version 0.5.2, October 2026). The details are in FEATURES.md; this is the shelf, not the books.

ROOM	WHAT IS THERE
Home	Good evening by name; today's minutes against the goal on a ribbon by room; Next up, one click each; the week; first steps for new learners; the next grammar topic and Mundus's suggestion. A Classic layout a setting away.
Cursus	The course for the six core languages: twelve units A1–B1 as an adventure trail, each with words, phrases, grammar, speaking, writing and a check. Grammatica (topics A1–B2 for the core six, short grammars for twelve more), Alphabets for seven scripts with writing, and keybr-style typing in the language's layout.
Codex	Read anything: EPUB, PDF, text, comics with speech bubbles read on the device, photos of printed pages, news, Wikipedia, Gutenberg and Wikisource, Goodreads shelves. Every word a click away, phrases by dragging, sentences translated ahead, the word panel, typography and papers, the end page, Check yourself.
Thesaurus and Ludus	Decks in folders, FSRS scheduling, 47 ready-made decks, Anki and CSV import, the offline dictionary for the core six (forms, recordings, etymology, Tatoeba), the word memory with every place a word was met. Ludus: choices, pairs, gaps, word banks, typing, speaking, letter tiles, listening and dictation, Lightning.

ROOM	WHAT IS THERE
Sonus et Visio	The library (songs, podcasts, episodes, audiobooks, stations, your files, films and videos); LibriVox and free courses; radio in the language with a tuner and live text; Sonus+ for music with timed lyrics, song lessons and podcasts; Visio for films and series with two interactive subtitle lines; Commute mode.
Mentis	Mundus, the guide (a note on your week, three next steps, Explore, Things to try); Sermo (scenes that open your own AI app); Diarium, the journal, checked by AI with Max, with a word diff and corrections to cards.
Ratio	Statistics for words, reading, listening, cards, writing, time and habit; Tabula, the table of every language you speak.
Settings	Eight groups with search: reading, cards, listening, languages, look and feel, AI and translation, your data, about.

Across the whole app

- Works offline as an installed desktop app, and updates itself at a quiet moment.
- Your devices sync directly, device to device, with no account and no server; backups as files.
- Natural voices: real speakers' recordings, Piper voices on the device, Gemini with a key.
- Paper and Nocturne, twelve palettes, six reading fonts, and a touch of each core language in the design.
- Keyboard first: Alt 1–8 for the rooms, letters for words, a shortcut sheet.

What it doesn't do yet is the rest of this part: Lingua 5.2's open rooms, Lingua 7's design pass and Lingua 6's features.

CHAPTER 5

Languages and tiers

WHERE

`TIERS` and `LANGUAGES` in `src/core/lang/languages.ts`.

Seventy languages, in five tiers that say honestly how much Lingua has for each. A tier is a promise: nothing on the page may claim more.

TIER	LANGUAGES	WHAT THEY GET
Core	6	Everything: the course, grammar, the alphabet, typing, the full dictionary, natural voices, every room
Full	14	Every room, grammar and the alphabet; no course
Beta	20	What builds itself: the reader, a dictionary, cards and Ludus, podcasts, radio, music search
Basics	20	Reading with tap-to-translate, your own words and decks, radio and podcasts
Experimental	10	Reading with machine translation where it exists

RULE

Tier 2 stays cheap: only features that cost little to keep (automatic packs, decks, podcasts, music search). CLAUDE.md.

The core six are Spanish, French, German, Russian, Arabic and Mandarin. Languages not built yet are shown with Soon and can't be chosen.

For marketing: say "six languages with everything, and sixty-four more to read and listen in". Never "70 languages" alone: it sounds like seventy courses.

CHAPTER 6

Adding a language

A language climbs the tiers one step at a time, and each step is real work. Never list a language higher than what is built and checked for it.

HOW

`docs/SETUP.md`, section 5, has every command. Pack builds take 1–2 GB of memory each: one at a time, dev server stopped.

TO REACH	WHAT IT TAKES
Experimental	An entry in `LANGUAGES`: code, name, endonym, script, flags, a sample line. Reading with machine translation where it exists.
Basics	Its flag or emblem in `design/flags.tsx`; radio stations and podcasts found in the language.
Beta	A language pack from Wiktionary (kaikki) and FrequencyWords: `fetch.ts`, `count.ts` where needed, `build.ts`. Then decks, Ludus and music search come by themselves.
Full	Grammatica topics, each checked against a named source; the alphabet if it has its own script; Mundus's picks chosen by hand.
Core	The full dictionary (`dictionary-fetch.ts`, `dictionary.ts`), recordings (`recordings.ts`), typing (`typing/build.ts`), the twelve-unit course, a language touch, a Piper voice where one exists, and a native reader's check (next chapter).

Tier 2 stays cheap: below Core, only what builds itself or costs little to keep. A new Core language is a Lingua-sized step of its own, planned like one.

RAISING A PACK

A higher `PACK_VERSION` makes installed packs refresh quietly.

CHAPTER 7

Getting the language right

A learner believes every sentence Lingua shows them. A language app is only as good as its language.

ALREADY DONE
The commonest words' meanings hand-checked in Spanish, French, German and Russian (5.1–3a).

Name the source. Every grammar rule is checked against a named source, listed under it, as Grammatica already does. Data keeps its origin: Wiktionary, Tatoeba, Lingua Libre, each with its licence.

A native reader before Core. Before a language becomes Core, and before the interface is translated into it (Lingua 6-19), someone who speaks it natively reads the course, the grammar and the interface. Pay them or thank them by name on the credits page.

Say which variety. Castilian or Mexican Spanish, European or Brazilian Portuguese: the flag's accent decides the voice, and the words say which they are.

Generated text is a draft. It is labelled, checked before it is shown (Lingua 6-6) and can be reported.

TEST SENTENCES
A fixed handful per language (forms, right to left, Japanese without spaces) read in the reader before each release.

Reports become fixes. A wrong meaning reported by a learner goes on a list, is fixed at the next pack build, and the learner is thanked.

CHAPTER 8

Plans and prices

Free is generous, Lingua+ is bought once, Max is AI with your own key. Never pushy.

	FREE	LINGUA+ · €24.99 ONCE	MAX · €5.99 A MONTH, €49.99 A YEAR
Codex	Everything: reading, look-ups, imports, Discover	—	AI sentence translation, Explain in context
Thesaurus	Unlimited decks and cards, Discover	Ludus	—
Sonus et Visio	Library, audiobooks, radio, your files	Sonus+, streaming and subtitles	Automatic dictation
Cursus	Alphabets	The course, Grammatica, typing	Feedback on writing and speaking
Mentis	Mundus, Diarium	Sermo	Diary checking, natural AI voices
Ratio, Settings	Everything	—	—

Max includes all of Lingua+ while it runs; whoever bought Lingua+ keeps it forever. Max's AI runs on the learner's own free key (Groq or Gemini), so Lingua has no AI server and no AI bill.

The honest bit to explain: Max asks for a monthly price and the learner's own key. Its page must say plainly what Max adds, that the key is free from its provider, and that the provider is separate from Lingua.

DECIDED

D1–D4 and D8 of the 5.1 plan (2026-10-20). Stripe; prices as above.

UNTIL STRIPE IS LIVE

Test mode: buying switches the plan and charges nothing. Installs from before the plans act as Max.

CHAPTER 9

Where Lingua is going

Each Lingua is a plan of its own, built step by step, each step pushed with a version.



QUEUE

`docs/HANDOVER.md`, steps 14–18, 22 and 21.

PLAN

`docs/LINGUA-6-PLAN.md` and the audit `LINGUA-6-FEATURES.md`; step 23. Versions 0.6.x.

PLAN

`docs/LINGUA-7-PLAN.md`; step 24. Versions 0.7.x.

VERSIONS

`docs/VERSIONS.md`.

Lingua 5.2 still has its rooms open: Visio (claimed), Diarium, Sermo, Mundus, Grammatica's guided path and Ratio, then its check, which makes version 0.5.2.

Lingua 6 · Features comes next (your call, 26 October): it adds what the Lingyu catalogue has and Lingua doesn't, foundations first. The next chapter is its summary.

Lingua 7 · Design follows, room by room from your notes, starting with the first start. This book is its guide.

1.0 is the first public release. The version leaves alpha (0.x) only when you say so.

CHAPTER 10

Lingua 6 · Features

On 26 October 2026 every entry of the Lingyu catalogue, all 1,618, was checked against Lingua. Most of the core is there; the gaps are deep rather than wide.

THE AUDIT

`docs/LINGUA-6-FEATURES.md`: each entry ticked or given the step that builds it.



437 there · 262 partly · 834 missing · 38 in 5.2 · 47 to decide

Foundations first

Many entries are one thing seen from several rooms: synonym cards, synonym races, synonym maps and a synonym finder while writing all come from one source. So Lingua 6 builds six shared pieces first, and the rooms grow on them. That keeps 1,143 entries from becoming 1,143 separate features.

PART A

The word record · the inbox and decks · cards and memory · one exercise engine · the learner's record · generated materials, checked.

The same rules as always

- Every feature lands in a room that exists; new tabs only where a room needs one.
- Local first; AI only with Max and the learner's key; estimates labelled.
- Hand-made content for the core six; what builds itself for the rest.
- Everything generated is checked before it is shown, and labelled.
- Saving is not scheduling: previews before a deck grows.

The 28 steps, in seven parts

A · FOUNDATIONS

6-1 The word record
6-2 The inbox and the deck workshop
6-3 Cards and memory
6-4 One exercise engine
6-5 The learner's record
6-6 Generated materials, checked

B · THE SKILLS

6-7 Grammar
6-8 Reading
6-9 Listening
6-10 Sounds and pronunciation
6-11 Speaking
6-12 Writing
6-13 Translating and comparing

C · PATHS AND GUIDANCE

6-14 Courses and lessons
6-15 The tutor, in context
6-16 Personal and adaptive
6-17 Goals, habits and progress
6-18 Exams and levels

D · MORE OF THE LANGUAGE

6-19 Immersion and culture
6-20 Phrasebook, notebook, word map
6-21 Games and projects
6-22 Dictionary tools
6-23 Tools for each language

E · AROUND THE APP

6-24 Import, export, integrations
6-25 Accessibility and the desktop

F · WITH YOUR WORD ONLY

6-26 Experiments
6-27 Together, and beyond the desk

G

6-28 The check; version 0.6.0

Your answers (26 October 2026)

Q1	Which first, Lingua 7 or Lingua 6?	**Lingua 6 first**, then Lingua 7
Q2	Sharing by files and links, or a server with accounts?	**Still to be considered**
Q3	A live voice conversation inside Lingua again?	**No**
Q4	The interface in the language you learn?	**Yes**
Q5	Streaks optional, stamps not points, reminders off by default?	**Yes**
Q6	Phone apps and widgets still decided against?	**Can be**: not ruled out

Q2 and Q6 stay open: nothing in step 6-27 is built until you schedule it.

PART THREE

The materials

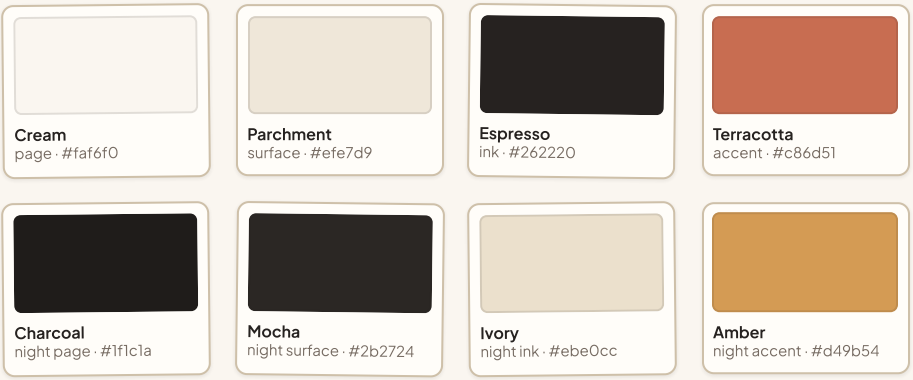
Paper, ink, type, space, motion, and the little drawings.



CHAPTER 11

Paper and ink

Lingua's light is called Paper and its dark is Nocturne. Neither is the other turned inside out: Paper is cream with espresso ink, Nocturne a warm charcoal with ivory, so nothing is ever pure white or pure black.



TEXT IN THE ACCENT

Use `--accent-text` (#a5533b), which keeps 4.5 : 1 on cream. `--accent` itself is for decoration in Paper.

SAGE

#6b8e78; its text #4f6f5b. At night #93b39e.

INVERSE

#3b302a on #f8efe0; at night #e8d8bb with #2b231e.

The accent is a bookmark, not a highlighter. One terracotta thing per area: the chosen language, the next step, the new word. If two things on one card are terracotta, one of them is wrong.

Sage means known, done or growing: a ticked step, a word you know, a finished chapter.

Tooltips, toasts and main buttons are inverse: espresso with cream by day, old-paper cream with espresso at night. Never black, never white.

Palettes and reading papers

The learner picks a palette for each light, and a paper for reading in Codex. Design in Cream and Charcoal, then look at one more of each before you call it done. A page that only works in Cream isn't done.

PAPER



NOCTURNE



Reading papers, by day: Cream, Ivory, Parchment, Sepia, Sage, Blush and Stone. By night: Charcoal, Espresso, Sepia night, Ink, Forest, Plum and Midnight. The paper turns with the light, in the same transition.

Use the tokens, never a colour by hand. A palette swaps the page, the surfaces and the accent. A colour typed in by hand is right in one palette and wrong in eleven.

WHERE

`src/design/palettes.ts`, `src/design/papers.ts`. The first of each list is the original look.

CONTRAST

Each palette's accent text is chosen to keep 4.5 : 1 on its own page. Ink keeps the theme's own.

TOKENS

`--bg --surface --raised --sunken --ink --ink-soft --ink-faint --line --line-strong --accent --accent-text --accent-fill --sage`

CHAPTER 12

Type

Two voices. Literata is the book: the titles, the language, and the numbers that matter. Plus Jakarta Sans is the helper: labels, buttons, explanations. When in doubt, ask who is speaking.

LITERATA

Am Abend lasen wir am Fenster, während draußen leise Schnee fiel.

PLUS JAKARTA SANS

Continue with Deutsch · Click a country to see what's spoken there.

WHERE	FACE	SIZE
Big moments (your name, the welcome)	Literata 600	40–44 px
A page's title	Literata 600, tight	30–36 px
A line in the language	Literata	19 px
Body and buttons	Jakarta	15 px
Small lines under things	Jakarta	12.5 px
Labels, in capitals	Jakarta 700, +0.08 em	11.5–12 px

WHERE

`--font-serif`, `--font-sans` in `src/styles/index.css`; reading fonts in `src/design/fonts.ts`.

The learner picks the reading font, so design for all six: Literata, Lora, Newsreader, Merriweather, Atkinson Hyperlegible and Comfortaa. Scripts they don't cover fall back to Noto Serif SC, JP and KR, Noto Naskh Arabic, or the device's own faces.

Numbers in a table line up (tabular). Numbers in a sentence are the book's own, set in the serif: "8 of 15 minutes".

CHAPTER 13

Space, corners and light

A Lingua page breathes like a well-set book: generous margins, one clear column, and things grouped by space before they are grouped by boxes.

Lines before shadows. A hairline separates; a shadow lifts. Most things only need the line. When something does float, one shadow is enough, and it is warm, never grey.

LIGHT

elev-1 a card at rest · **elev-2** something floating: the map, a popover · **elev-3** dialogs and drawers. All tinted espresso.



Round, not bubbly. Pills for small choices, generous corners for cards and dialogs, gentler ones inside them. An inner corner is always smaller than the one around it.

TAILWIND

Buttons `rounded-lg/xl/2xl` by size; cards and dialogs `rounded-3xl`; empty states `rounded-2xl`.

One screen. A desktop page fits 1366 × 768 without a scroll bar. If it doesn't fit, take something away before making something smaller.

SINCE

2026-10-25, `5c044f9`: desktop screens on one screen, no tiny scroll.

Columns over stacks. A sticky rail for filters, a panel beside a list, two cards side by side that end on the same line.

CHAPTER 14

Motion

Things in Lingua settle like paper: they move a little, then they are still. Motion says where something came from. It never performs.

SPRING	FOR	STIFFNESS · DAMPING
snappy	pills, toggles, indicators	560 · 42
soft	cards and page content	320 · 34
sheet	drawers and sheets	400 · 40
gentle	the first start's pages	200 · 28
fluid	full motion: pages, reordering	210 · 26

WHERE

`src/design/motion.ts`; the rules in `docs/PERFORMANCE.md`.

FULL MOTION

A setting: pages rise 18 px and settle on *fluid*.

Only transform and opacity move. Never a width, a height or a top: the reader has to stay at sixty frames a second.

The first start turns its pages, 48 pixels sideways with a six-degree tilt. Elsewhere, pages rise 8 pixels as they appear.

Reduced motion means none, not less.

Nothing is slower than the learner. If they click again before something has finished moving, the second click wins.



not this slow

CHAPTER 15

Drawings, icons and flags

Drawings are one fine line in the colour of soft ink, with one small thing in terracotta: a bookmark, a tick, a wisp of sound. They are small, and they never explain what the words already say.

THE LINE

Stroke 1.3, round caps and joins, `currentColor` in `ink-soft`. See the open book and the three vignettes in `IntroPages.tsx`.



Icons are Lucide, as lines. A room keeps its icon wherever it appears: the sidebar, Home, a link from another room.

Flags are drawn, all the same size and corner. Where one country's flag would be wrong for a language, it gets its own emblem (the Senyera for Catalan, the Ikurriña for Basque, the Frisian flag) or a badge with its script on soft paper: ਪੰ for Punjabi, Š / Ћ for Serbo-Croatian, सं for Sanskrit, ᚱ for Old Norse.

An empty page may have a drawing. A full page doesn't need one.

THIS BOOK

The little room drawings here are for the book only. In the app, the rooms use their Lucide icons.

WHERE

`src/design/flags.tsx`. Script badges set the glyph in the reading font on a paper square, so they sit calmly beside real flags.

A touch of the language

WHERE

`src/design/flavours.ts`, on by default: Settings › Look and feel › Language touches.

When you learn French, Lingua looks a little French. Each core language lends the app a heading face, one ornament and a lean of the accent. It is a touch, not a costume: the reading text and the learner's palette never change.

LANGUAGE	HEADINGS	ORNAMENT, AND MORE
French	Garamond	a fleuron, a hint of bleu de France
Spanish	Alegreya	a tile strip; ¿ in titles that ask
German	a clean grotesque	a straight rule
Russian	PT Serif	a thin red rule
Mandarin	a Song face	a vermilion seal for "done"
Arabic	Amiri	an eight-point star

QUOTES

In the language's own marks: « » for French, „ " for German, 「」 for Chinese and Japanese.

Where the touch shows: room titles, Home's greeting, dividers, empty states, the end of a book, the loading screen, and the first start once a language is chosen. Never in the text being read.

When you design a page, switch through the six. If the touch makes anything harder to read, the touch is wrong, not the page.



PART FOUR

Page by page

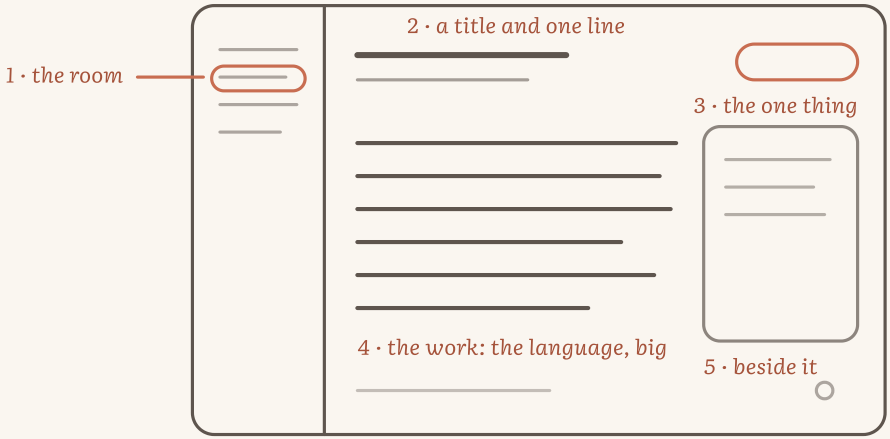
The anatomy of a page, the first start, and every room, one page each.



CHAPTER 16

The anatomy of a page

Most Lingua pages are made of the same five parts. Get these right and the page is nearly done.



USE THESE FIRST

Button, Card, Dialog, Drawer, EmptyState, Popover, SearchInput, Segmented, Select, Slider, Switch, Tooltip: `src/design/primitives`.

1. **The room,** lit in the sidebar. Nothing else tells you where you are.
2. **A title and one line.** The title in Literata; the line under it in the helper's voice, and that's where a smile goes.
3. **The one thing to do,** in the accent fill, top right or under the work. One per page.
4. **The work.** The language, a list, a player: the biggest, calmest thing.
5. **What's beside it, and the quiet edges:** a panel or rail; counts, More, settings.

CHAPTER 17 · LINGUA 7 BEGINS HERE

The first start

The first start is the first page of the book. It should feel like opening one: unhurried, a little exciting, and over before it gets long.

THE PLAN

Lingua 7-1 in `docs/LINGUA-7-PLAN.md`, from the user's notes of 2026-10-26. Code: `src/app/onboarding`.

Your name · Welcome · What Lingua can do · Language · Level · ~~You speak~~ · ~~Why~~ · Goal · Study light · Plans

Three pages to say hello, then four steps to set up, and the plans. "You speak" and "Why" were taken out: the fewer questions before the first page of reading, the better.

DOTS

Only the steps get dots, not the hello pages. Every page fits 1366 × 768, except the language page, where the list peeks in on purpose.

Your name

"First things first." One field for a first name, and Continue waits until there is one. No skip. The quiet line stays: "It stays on this device. We just like to be polite."

OUT

"Skip for now", and the Lingua mark above the title: the header already has the wordmark.

The language

The world first, wide. Click a country, and a panel opens with the country itself as its title, its flag and its name, set properly, then the languages you can learn there. No tabs. Under the map, the six core languages as small book covers, each wearing a touch of its language; under them every other language, larger than before, by tier. Each tier says plainly what it has and what it doesn't have yet.

TIERS

Core · Full · Beta · Basics · Experimental. One table, `TIERS` in `src/core/lang/languages.ts`, with *has* and *not yet*.



The level

THE CARD

Springs in on *snappy*; arrow keys move along the steps. From A2 up it says the most common words start as known.

Seven steps, A0 to C2, like a staircase. Hover one or choose it, and a small card pops up with what that level could mean: what you can read, follow and say there, and what Lingua will do about it. No example sentences, no test.



The goal

OUT

~~"B1 in about 7 months"~~, ~~"Ambitious. We like it."~~ Not accurate enough.

A level to aim for, and minutes a day. Nothing forecasts. Instead each choice says what it means: the goal in the level card's words, the minutes in what they hold in Lingua: "Cards, a few pages and a song."

Study light, and the plans

PLANS

`features/plans/PlanPitch`. Max shows monthly first.

Every palette as a small page of the app, with Follow my device first. Then the plans, which promise only what is true, with Continue free as clear as the rest.

Ask yourself

1. *Can someone reach the map in under a minute?*
2. *Does any page promise something Lingua can't measure?*
3. *Is there more than one joke on a page, or one inside an instruction?*

CHAPTER 18

Home

Your hearth



Coming home to the language: what you did today, and the one thing to do next.

SHOW FIRST	The greeting by name, today's minutes against the goal, and Next up.
KEEP QUIET	The week and its numbers, the Lingua+ button (free plan only), first steps once they're done.
THE ONE THING	The first row of Next up.

Home is a page you glance at, not one you study. A returning learner should be back in their book within a click, without reading a word of the interface.

TODAY

"Good evening, {name}"; minutes in serif numerals, "8 of 15 minutes", over a ribbon split by room. Next up: at most four rows. `features/home/HomeToday.tsx`.

Ask yourself

1. *Can a returning learner start in one click, without reading?*
2. *Is anything below fighting Next up for attention?*
3. *Does a brand-new learner see a way in, rather than empty numbers?*

ALSO

Home layout Today / Classic in Settings › Look and feel. Both columns end on the same line.



CHAPTER 19

Cursus

The course, grammar, alphabets and typing

Learning in order, for those who like a path: it leads, and everything stays open.

SHOW FIRST	The next point on the trail.
KEEP QUIET	Everything past the next few steps. Any topic can still be opened; it just isn't pushed.
THE ONE THING	Continue.

TABS

Course · Grammatica · Alphabets · Typing, keys 1–4, opening on the tab used last. The course is for the six core languages; the path became an adventure in 5.1-3.

A grammar rule is easiest to keep when it comes with a sentence you have already met. Wherever Cursus can, it borrows from what the learner read or heard.

Ask yourself

1. *Is the next step obvious, and is everything else still within reach?*
2. *Does a rule show a sentence the learner has actually met?*
3. *Does a lesson end by pointing back into reading or listening?*

DECIDED

D10 of the 5.1 plan: "It leads, everything stays open."

CHAPTER 20

Codex

Reading



Reading real things in the language, with every word a tap away. The heart of Lingua.

SHOW FIRST	The book you're reading. In the reader, the page and nothing else.
KEEP QUIET	Translations, grammar and the dictionary, in the word drawer, once a word is tapped.
THE ONE THING	Keep reading.

The reader is the one page that should feel like paper and nothing more. Words you are learning are marked kindly, not like mistakes; words you know are not marked at all.

Ask yourself

1. *Is the text the biggest, calmest thing on the screen?*
2. *Does closing the drawer put you back on the very word you tapped?*
3. *Does the end of a book feel like the end of a book?*

MARKS

New words on `--learning-bg` with `--learning-line`; unseen ones a sage line. Styles in `src/styles/reader.css`; papers per light.

ALSO HERE

Import a book or a comic; the end page with its ornament; the reading goal's note.



CHAPTER 21

Thesaurus and Ludus

Your words, and games with them

Every word you keep, and the practice that brings it back just in time.

SHOW FIRST	The cards due today, and the words you met most recently.
KEEP QUIET	The scheduling: intervals, ease, forecasts. There for those who look.
THE ONE THING	Study what's due.

CARDS

Width Thin · Normal · Wide, per deck if wanted. Discover; sentences with a gap as a Ludus mode; the word memory and the dictionary.

A word is more than its card. Wherever it shows, let it say where it was found: the book and the sentence, the song and the line.

Ask yourself

1. *Does every word show where it came from?*
2. *Is a card's answer hidden until the learner has tried?*
3. *Does practice end with a calm summary rather than a score to beat?*

CAREFUL

A saved word is not a known word. Count them separately, everywhere.

CHAPTER 22

Sonus et Visio

Listening and watching



Podcasts, radio, audiobooks, songs, films and shows, with the text following along.

SHOW FIRST	Continue: what's half-played or half-watched, and how much is left.
KEEP QUIET	Sources and services and their limits, until they matter. Then say them plainly.
THE ONE THING	Press play.

Only one thing plays at a time. A word looked up mid-song pauses the following, not the song, and the learner can find their line again with one click.

STRIP

+ Listen and + Watch; Library · Audiobooks · Radio · Streaming, and Sonus+ at the end. A sticky rail of categories in the library.

Ask yourself

1. *Can you look up a word without losing your place?*
2. *When a service can't do something, does the page say so instead of showing a dead button?*
3. *Is an empty library one calm card, not a wall of empty shelves?*

HONEST

Never imply Lingua includes someone else's subscription.



CHAPTER 23

Mentis

The guide, talking and writing

Using the language: Mundus suggests, Sermo talks, Diarium writes.

SHOW FIRST	Today's prompt: one thing to write, one thing to talk about.
KEEP QUIET	Scores and corrections, until the learner asks for them.
THE ONE THING	Start today's prompt.

AI

With the learner's own key (Groq, Gemini), and only with Max. A privacy note sits next to Check.

What the learner writes or says is theirs. Corrections sit beside the original, never over it, and each one can be taken or left.

Ask yourself

1. *Are the learner's own words still visible next to the corrections?*
2. *Is it clear what is sent away, and to whom, before anything is sent?*
3. *Can a talk or an entry be left half-done and found again?*

TABS

Mundus · Sermo · Diarium, with Today's prompt on the right of each.

CHAPTER 24

Ratio

How it's going



An honest look back: time, words, reading, listening, and the journey so far.

SHOW FIRST	This week, in a few numbers anyone understands.
KEEP QUIET	Every chart behind a tab or a hover.
THE ONE THING	None. Ratio is for looking; a goal can be changed from here.

Numbers are evidence, not grades. Each says what it counts and over how long. Where there isn't enough to say anything, Ratio says that kindly instead of drawing a flat line.

Ask yourself

1. *Does every number say what it counts, and since when?*
2. *Is a saved word ever called a known one?*
3. *Is any estimate labelled as one?*

TABS

Overview · Tabula · Iter, with a language filter. Charts in `src/design/charts`, each with a popover.

TABULA

The languages you speak, with level and notes; certificates can be added later.



CHAPTER 25

Settings and the plans

Everything you can change

Everything adjustable, in groups, with search, and the plans told straight.

SHOW FIRST	The groups, and the search.
KEEP QUIET	The fine options inside their group.
THE ONE THING	Find the setting.

PLANS

Lingua+ €24.99 once, every update included. Max €5.99 a month or €49.99 a year: AI with your own key. Through Stripe.

Things with consequences are named for what they do. Cancelling a renewal, disconnecting a service and deleting everything are three different things, and they never share a button called Remove.

Ask yourself

1. *Can someone export, delete or manage a subscription without help?*
2. *Does each plan say its price, what it includes and when it renews, next to its button?*
3. *Is "Continue free" as easy to see as the rest?*

NAME

Settings was called Ordo until 5.2-1.

CHAPTER 26

The new tabs of Lingua 6

Lingua 6 adds a few tabs to rooms that exist, and one button that appears everywhere. Each gets the same care as a room.

PLAN

`docs/LINGUA-6-PLAN.md`, the step named beside each.

TAB	SHOW FIRST	KEEP QUIET
Cursus › Sounds 6-10	The sound you're on, its drawing and recording, and Record	The full IPA charts; the waveform until you've recorded
Cursus › Exams 6-18	Your exam, the days left, the next task	Score ranges until a mock is done; past mocks
Thesaurus › Phrases 6-20	Phrases by situation, with sound	Templates and variants, until a phrase is opened
Thesaurus › Map 6-20	The word you came from, and its nearest neighbours	The whole map; filters in a rail
Mentis › Notebook 6-20	Your latest note, and a new one	Folders and tags in a rail; the error log a tab away
Ludus › Translate 6-13	The sentence to translate, large	Hints, references and the alignment view until asked
The inbox 6-2	Each word with its sentence, and three choices	Bulk actions until something is selected
Ask 6-15	A small button where the learning is	Everything: it opens a side panel, and closes back to the exact place

Ask yourself

1. *Is the new tab a place you'd go, or a feature that belongs inside another one?*
2. *Does anything generated say so, and can it be reported?*
3. *Does a word here open the same word's page as everywhere else?*

PART FIVE

Before you call it done

The states a page can be in, Lingua's check, and a sheet to tick.



CHAPTER 27

Every page's states

A page is not done when it looks right full. It is done when it also looks right empty, slow, wrong and offline.

The first time	Say why it's empty, and give one way in.
Loading	Keep the page's shape. If it takes more than a moment, say what's happening.
Nothing found	Show what was searched for, and a way to clear it.
Went wrong	Keep what the learner typed, say what failed, and offer to try again.
Offline	Say what still works. Most of Lingua does.
Not in this plan	Say what it is and what it costs, and that saying no loses nothing.
Coming	Dimmed, with a word on hover. Never a button that does nothing.
A lot	Five hundred books, ten thousand words: does it still breathe?

A toast is a whisper, not a record. Anything the learner must know stays on the page after the toast has gone.

Never show a stack trace, a key or someone else's anything.

PRIMITIVES

`EmptyState` for the first time and nothing found; `Toaster` for whispers.

KEYS

Stay on the device, travel only in request headers, never in a URL.

CHAPTER 28

The check

Lingua's own check, for every page you touch. It takes ten minutes and saves the user an evening.

FROM

`CLAUDE.md`, "How the user wants each prompt handled".

- [ ] `npm run typecheck`
- [ ] `npm test`
- [ ] `npm run build`

Then look at it

- [ ] at 1280, 1440 and a 1366 × 768 laptop
- [ ] in Paper and in Nocturne, two palettes each
- [ ] with the language touches on and off
- [ ] with reduced motion on
- [ ] with the keyboard only: can you reach everything, and see where you are?
- [ ] with a long word, a long name, Arabic from right to left, and Japanese without spaces
- [ ] at Windows' 125% scaling

Then finish it

Update the docs it touches (the roadmap, decisions, features), tick the step in the handover, give the push its version, rebase, push, and check the site went live.

VERSION

`node scripts/version.ts "…"`; Lingua 6 is `0.6.0-alpha.N`, then Lingua 7 `0.7.0-alpha.N`. See `docs/VERSIONS.md`.

CHAPTER 29

The review sheet

Page _____ Date _____

THE SPIRIT

- [ ] The language is the biggest thing
- [ ] One main thing to do
- [ ] The rest folded, not taken away
- [ ] Nothing promised that isn't built
- [ ] Nothing added behind the learner's back

THE LOOK

- [ ] Tokens only; no colour by hand
- [ ] One terracotta thing per area
- [ ] Literata for the language and titles
- [ ] Lines before shadows
- [ ] Fits 1366 × 768, no tiny scroll
- [ ] Only transform and opacity move

THE WORDS

- [ ] The title asks or names
- [ ] At most one smile, never in an instruction
- [ ] Buttons say what happens
- [ ] Plain words for money, privacy, errors

THE STATES

- [ ] The first time
- [ ] Loading keeps the shape
- [ ] Nothing found, with a way back
- [ ] An error keeps what was typed
- [ ] Offline says what works
- [ ] Coming is dimmed, not dead

THE CHECK

- [ ] Typecheck, tests, build
- [ ] Paper and Nocturne, two palettes each
- [ ] Language touches on and off
- [ ] Reduced motion
- [ ] Keyboard only
- [ ] Right to left, and no spaces

NOTES

PART SIX

The people it's for

Who Lingua is for, who it isn't for, what else they use, and how to keep listening to them.



CHAPTER 30

Who Lingua is for

Adults who learn a language by living in it: reading, listening and watching real things, at a desk, in the evening, on purpose.

SKETCHES, NOT RESEARCH

These five are the people Lingua is built for, written down so they can be tested. The private beta (Part Seven) checks them against real learners; change them when it does.

Mara, the reader

B1 IN SPANISH

WANTS	To read a whole novel, and keep the words she looks up.
TIRED OF	Apps that teach “the apple is red” for the hundredth time.
IN LINGUA	Codex, the word panel, the inbox; Discover’s classics.
PAYS FOR	Lingua+ once, for Ludus and the course’s grammar.

Tomás, the watcher

A2 IN FRENCH

WANTS	To follow series and songs without pausing every line.
TIRED OF	Juggling a subtitle add-on, a dictionary and a flashcard app.
IN LINGUA	Visio’s two lines, Sonus+ lyrics, lines saved as cards that replay their clip.
PAYS FOR	Lingua+ for Sonus+ and streaming; Max for transcripts.

Ines, the polyglot

FOUR LANGUAGES, TWO DORMANT

WANTS	To keep several languages alive and see them side by side.
TIRED OF	One app per language, and streaks that punish a week off.
IN LINGUA	Tabula, switching languages, Ratio, the radio while cooking.
PAYS FOR	Lingua+ once; it covers every language.

Jonas, the serious beginner

A0 IN RUSSIAN

WANTS	A path that leads, a new alphabet, real progress by summer.
TIRED OF	Games that feel like learning and aren't.
IN LINGUA	Alphabets, the course trail, Grammatica, typing practice.
PAYS FOR	Lingua+ for the course.

Lea, the student

B2 GOAL IN GERMAN, AN EXAM IN JUNE

WANTS	To pass the Goethe exam, and write and speak with confidence.
TIRED OF	Practice tests with no feedback.
IN LINGUA	Diarium checked, Sermo's scenes; Exams when Lingua 6 brings them.
PAYS FOR	Max during the months before the exam.

What they share: a laptop, a little time most days, a dislike of noise, and a wish to own their learning rather than rent it.

CHAPTER 31

Who it isn’t for, honestly

Saying who Lingua isn’t for keeps it good for the people it is for, and keeps the marketing honest.

Five minutes on the bus	Lingua is a desk app. Phone apps “can be” (your answer, 26 October), but not now.
Children	The voice, the content and the AI are made for adults.
Streak hunters	No hearts, no leagues, no guilt. Some people want those; they have good options.
A certificate	Lingua estimates levels; it doesn’t certify them.
A human teacher	Lingua helps between lessons. “Ask a speaker” points to people; it isn’t one.
A course in any language	The course is for the six core languages. Others read, listen and keep words.

When someone writes that Lingua isn’t for them, thank them and point them to something that is. Being useful when you lose a customer is how you keep a name.

IN THE FAQ

“Is Lingua for me?” with this list, kindly worded.

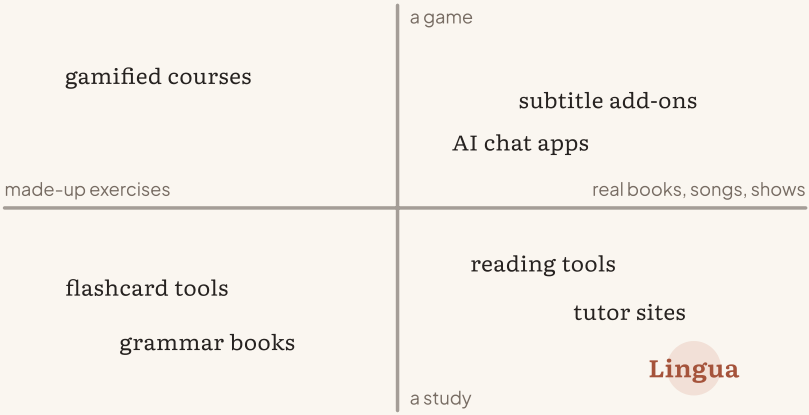
CHAPTER 32

What else they use

KINDS, NOT NAMES

Products change their features and prices often. Compare by kind here; check the real ones on the day you write about them.

Most learners use three or four tools at once. Lingua's place is the quiet desk where those tools' best parts live together.



COMPARISONS

In the EU, comparative advertising must be accurate and verifiable. Never name a competitor's weakness you can't show.

Lingua sits low and right: a study, built on real material. Its difference is not one feature but the joining up: the word met in a song is the card, the gap in a lesson and the line in your journal.

KIND	WHY LEARNERS LOVE IT	WHERE LINGUA IS DIFFERENT
Gamified courses	Easy to start, a little every day	Real material from the first weeks; no streak pressure
Flashcard tools	Powerful memory, endlessly flexible	Cards made from what you read and hear, with their sentence and sound
Reading tools	Import anything, look up everything	Bought once; also listening, watching, grammar and a course
Subtitle add-ons	Learn from the shows you watch	The same words then live in your decks and dictionary
AI chat apps	A patient partner at any hour	Lingua opens your own AI with the right scene and your words
Tutor sites	Real people, real conversation	Lingua is for the hours between lessons

Why someone would choose Lingua

- Everything in one calm place, joined by the words.
- Bought once; the free part is generous and stays free.
- Private: on your device, no account, your own AI key.
- It looks and feels like a good book, not a slot machine.

Why they wouldn't, yet

- No phone app; no friends or leagues; courses for six languages only.
- A new name from one maker: trust has to be earned in public.

CHAPTER 33

Listening to learners

Lingua collects nothing about how it's used, so learning about learners is done the old way: by asking, and by reading what they write.

Five questions for a beta learner

1. *Tell me about the last time you studied your language. What did you do?*
2. *What did you open Lingua for this week, and what happened?*
3. *Where did you get stuck or lost?*
4. *What would you miss if Lingua disappeared tomorrow?*
5. *Who do you know who should try it, and why them?*

Ask about what people did, not what they would do. "Would you pay for …" gets polite yeses; "what did you pay for last" gets the truth.

KEEP NOTES

One page per conversation in the notebook (or a folder): who, when, the five answers, one thing to change. Read them all before planning a step.

Every support email and review is a short interview. Keep a running list of what people ask for, with how many asked; it is the honest version of a feature vote.

PART SEVEN

Telling people

The story, the words, the website, where to find learners, the launch, and counting without spying.



CHAPTER 34

The story in one line

Learn a language by living in it.

USE IT

The line on the cover of the website, in the app's first page, and at the end of every post.

In a sentence: Lingua is a quiet study on your computer where you read, listen and watch real things in a language, and every word you meet is kept and comes back just before you'd forget it.

In thirty seconds

Most apps teach you made-up sentences. Lingua lets you learn from the real thing: a novel, a podcast, a song, a series. Tap any word and it's explained; keep it, and Lingua brings it back as a card, in a game, in a lesson, in your journal. For six languages there's a full course too. It runs on your computer, keeps your data there, and Lingua+ is bought once.

Four things to say again and again

Live in it	Real books, songs, radio and shows, from the first weeks.
Keep every word	One word, everywhere: met once, never lost.
A calm desk	No ads, no streak guilt, no noise. It looks like a good book.
Yours	On your device, no account, bought once, your own AI key.

The positioning, for your own notes: for adults who learn by reading, listening and watching, Lingua is the desktop study that joins every immersion tool around one record of your words, bought once and private, unlike streak games and subscription readers.

CHAPTER 35

Words for selling

Marketing speaks in the app's own voice (see "The voice"), with one more rule: every claim must be true on the day it's read.

WE MAY SAY	WE NEVER SAY
Read real books with every word a click away	Fluent in three months
Six languages with a full course	Seventy languages (alone)
Bought once, every update while Lingua is made	Lifetime access, forever, guaranteed
Your data stays on your device	100% secure
AI with your own free key, through Max	Free AI tutor; replaces teachers
Try everything free; buy when you're sure	Only today! Last chance!
Built by one person who learns languages too	A team of experts

Screenshots and videos show the app as it is, with real text from public-domain books, never a mock-up of a feature that isn't built.

Gifts are said: a creator who got a free licence says so in the review. That is the law in the EU and simple decency anywhere.

WATCH

"Lifetime" and "updates for life" are promises a buyer can hold you to. Say what you can keep.

CHAPTER 36

The website

WHERE

A page of its own on a domain of yours; the app stays at its address (today `sanchour.github.io/lingua`). The domain is your decision.

One calm page that shows the reader working, says what it costs, and gets Lingua installed in a minute.

The home page, top to bottom

1. ***The line and the reader,*** *moving: a page of a real book, a word clicked, its panel, saved.*
2. ***Three things,*** *in the fine drawings: read anything, keep every word, listen and watch.*
3. ***The rooms,*** *one line each, with a still of each.*
4. ***Languages:*** *the core six, then "and 64 more to read and listen in".*
5. ***Plans:*** *the table from "Plans and prices", as on the plans sheet; Continue free as clear as Buy.*
6. ***Private by design:*** *what stays on the device, what goes where.*
7. ***Questions:*** *is it for me, phones, my data, refunds, the AI key.*
8. ***Install:*** *one button, and the two steps for Chrome and Edge.*

ALSO

A credits page (every open source Lingua uses), the privacy policy, terms of sale, contact.

Pages that find people: one per core language ("Read in Spanish with every word explained") and one per way of learning ("Learn French from songs"), each true and useful on its own.

CHAPTER 37

The mark and the press kit

Make it easy to write about Lingua well: one folder with everything a writer or a creator needs, all of it true.

THE ICON

Two solid pages and a ribbon, on warm paper or warm charcoal (4.0-1). Generated with `npm run icons`.

The mark

The icon and the wordmark as the app shows them, on Cream or Charcoal, with room around them. Never stretched, never outlined, never in a colour outside the palette's ink and accent.

The press kit, a page on the website

- The one line, and a description of about a hundred words.
- The mark as SVG and PNG, light and dark.
- Six screenshots at 1440 wide, in Cream and Charcoal, with real public-domain text: the reader first, then one per room.
- A thirty-second screen recording of a word met, kept and found again.
- Prices and plans; what is free.
- A few lines about the maker, a contact, and the offer of a free licence for review.

A PICTURE FOR LINKS: 1200 × 630, the open book drawing and the line on Cream. It is what people see when someone shares the website.

CHAPTER 38

Where to find learners

For one maker with no budget: places where learners already gather, and things worth sharing there.

WHERE	HOW	CAREFUL
Learner communities	Language-learning forums and subreddits, a language's own communities and Discord servers. Share something useful (a method, a free deck), mention Lingua when it fits.	Each place's rules on self-promotion
Creators	Learners who make videos about immersion and reading. A free Lingua+ licence, no script, an honest review.	The gift disclosed
Launch sites	A launch on a product site and a "show" post on a developer forum: the local-first, bought-once, private angle.	One day, be there all day
Teachers and tutors	Lingua for the hours between lessons; a teacher's note and a free licence for their own use.	Never ask them to sell
Universities	Language centres and student societies.	Slow; worth it
A desktop store	The Microsoft Store can list a PWA (PWABuilder packages it).	An account; your decision
Word of mouth	The generous free part; a "Tell a friend" that copies a line.	No referral nagging

Not yet: paid advertising. Until the beta says who Lingua is truly for, ads would pay to find the wrong people.

CHAPTER 39

Content that teaches

The best marketing for a learning app is learning. Write and film things a learner is glad to find, whether or not they ever install Lingua.

Ideas that come from Lingua itself

- The thirty-one methods (section 4 of the Lingua 6 plan), one short guide each.
- "Your first novel in Spanish": which book, how, in what order, from a public-domain shelf.
- Songs to learn French with, by level; radio stations worth a morning.
- How a word stays: spaced repetition explained without the jargon.
- What's new in Lingua: every version, in the changelog's plain words.
- Screen recordings, a minute each: a comic's bubbles read, a song's lines saved, a book becoming a deck.

A monthly rhythm

Week 1	One guide
Week 2	One short video
Week 3	One useful thing shared in a community
Week 4	A letter to learners: what's new, one tip, one thank-you

Small and steady beats loud and rare. If a month is too full, keep only the letter.

CHAPTER 40

The launch

Three stages, each ending when it has taught what it can.

1 · Quietly (now)

VERSION
0.x, alpha.

The alpha: you and a few friends. Lingua 5 finished and checked; Lingua 6's foundations; the business set up (Part Eight). Ends when you'd hand it to a stranger without apologising.

2 · A private beta

ENDS WHEN
Most still open Lingua after three weeks, and you can say in their words why.

Twenty to fifty learners from the communities in "Where to find learners", chosen to match the five sketches. Free Lingua+ for them. A short letter each week; two conversations a week with the five questions. Fix what stops people; note what delights them.

3 · Version 1.0

VERSION
1.0.0 (VERSIONS.md: alpha ends at the first public release).

The public release, when you say so: the website, Stripe live, the launch week on the next page. Then listen, fix fast, and thank people by name.

Launch week

The week before	Website, plans and install page checked; Stripe live with a real purchase and a refund tested; support inbox and FAQ ready; the beta learners told first.
Day 1	The letter to everyone who asked; the launch-site post; be there all day to answer.
Day 2	The developer-forum post, on the local-first angle.
Day 3–4	One useful post in each learner community that welcomes it.
Day 5	Creators' reviews go live (licences sent two weeks before).
Day 6–7	Answer everything; write down every request; fix what broke.
The week after	A thank-you letter with what changed because of them.

If it goes quietly, that is normal. Most good small apps grow by being kept, not by launching loudly. Keep the monthly rhythm.



LAUNCH OFFER

If any, honest: a real end date said from the start, never a fake countdown.

CHAPTER 41

Counting without spying

DECISION

Any measuring inside the app would change the privacy promise: only with your word, opt-in, and said on the privacy page.

Lingua sends nothing about how it's used, and that is a promise worth keeping. You can still know how it's going.

NUMBER	FROM	TELLS YOU
Visitors and where from	Cookie-free site statistics (an option to choose)	Which channels work
Lingua+ sold, Max started	Stripe	Whether the free part leads somewhere
Max kept, cancelled	Stripe's portal	Whether AI is worth its price
Refunds and their reasons	Stripe, emails	Who Lingua disappointed
Licences claimed	The licence server	Paying learners, roughly
Questions and requests	The support inbox	What to build and fix
How it's going	Opt-in "How's Lingua?" once, after two weeks	The feeling, in their words

Look once a week, on the same day, in one small table. A number moving once is noise; three weeks in a row is a story.

PART EIGHT

Running it

Money, privacy and the law, support, shipping, and working with Claude across accounts.



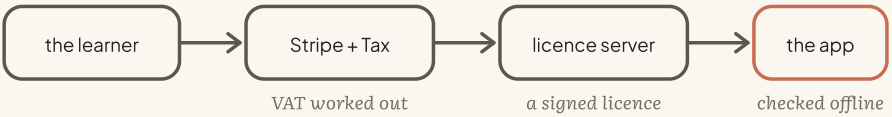
CHAPTER 42

Money

SETUP

`server/licence/README.md`, step by step, test mode first.

The learner pays on Stripe's own page; a tiny server turns the payment into a signed licence; the app checks it offline. No AI and no learning data pass through.



What has to be set up (by you)

- A business where you live, and a bank account for it.
- Stripe, with Stripe Tax on, and the EU's VAT one-stop shop (Stripe works the VAT out; the return is yours, each quarter).
- Three Payment Links, the customer portal, the key pair, the Cloudflare Worker.
- An accountant, even a small one, for the first year.

CHECK

Stripe's current fees on its pricing page before doing sums; they differ by card and country.

Costs today are close to none: GitHub Pages and Cloudflare's free tier host everything; a domain costs a few euros a year; Stripe takes a fee per payment.

What one Lingua+ leaves you

ONLY AN ILLUSTRATION

Your VAT rate, Stripe's fee and taxes on profit are yours to check.

Prices include VAT, which belongs to the buyer's country. A worked example, with the numbers as assumptions to replace:

Price paid	€24.99
VAT inside it, at 21 % (e.g. the Netherlands)	− €4.34
Net price	€20.65
Stripe's fee, assumed 1.5 % + €0.25 of the price paid	− €0.62
Left, before income tax	**about €20.03**

The sum, for any price: left = price ÷ (1 + VAT) − fee(price). Do it once for Lingua+, Max monthly and Max yearly, and keep the table beside your prices.

Refunds

YOUR DECISION

The rule, and its words in the terms of sale.

A suggestion: refund Lingua+ within fourteen days, no questions asked, and say so on the plans page. It costs little, earns trust, and buyers in the EU often have a right to withdraw anyway.

Honest limits of the licence

An app that runs on the device can be unlocked by someone determined. The licence stops casual sharing, not that. Spend no time fighting it; spend it on the people who pay.

CHAPTER 43

Privacy, licences and the law

EU
Lingua is sold from the EU, so the GDPR, consumer law and VAT rules apply.

What to have in writing before strangers pay. Not legal advice: have it read once by someone who knows.

Privacy policy	What stays on the device (all learning data); what goes where (Stripe for payments; the licence server: the checkout and the email; AI and translation providers with the learner's own key; look-ups and media from the open services Lingua names); no analytics, no ads, no selling.
Terms of sale	What Lingua+ and Max are, how Max renews and is cancelled, refunds, what "updates" means, the licence's limits.
Business details	Name, address and registration on the website, as EU law expects of a seller.
The name	"Lingua" is a common word used by many apps: search the EU's trademark register (TMview) before printing it on anything, and consider a distinctive mark.
Open content	Credits and licences for every source (Wiktionary and Lingua Libre CC BY-SA, Tatoeba CC BY, fonts under the OFL, Piper's voices each with its own licence, CLDR, LibriVox and Gutenberg's terms); Settings › About lists them: keep it complete.
Accessibility	The EU's accessibility rules exempt the smallest businesses for services, but step 6-25 is worth doing anyway.
Keys	API keys stay on the device and travel only in headers (CLAUDE.md); say so on the privacy page.

CHAPTER 44

Support

One inbox, answered by a person, in Lingua's voice. Promise a reply within two working days, and keep it.

The questions that will come

- Installing on Windows and Mac; why there's no phone app (yet).
- Moving to a new computer: device pairing, or a backup file.
- A licence lost: Settings › Lingua+ › Restore, with the licence key.
- Max and the AI key: where to get a free key, why Lingua asks for one.
- Refunds, and cancelling Max in the customer portal.
- A word with the wrong meaning; a station that doesn't play.

Each answered twice becomes a line in the FAQ. Each bug gets a note in the known-issues list on the website until it's fixed.

WORTH ADDING

A "Report a problem" that opens an email with the version and the room filled in (the Lab's reports already know them).

A reply, for example

Thanks for writing, and sorry the radio went quiet. That station changed its address yesterday; the fix is in version 0.6.0-alpha.12, which your Lingua will install by itself the next time it's closed. Happy listening.

CHAPTER 45

Shipping

WHERE

`docs/DEPLOY.md`, `docs/VERSIONS.md`, `.github/workflows/deploy.yml`.

Every push to main is a release: GitHub Pages builds it, and installed apps update themselves at a quiet moment, never while someone is studying.

Every push

1. *The check: typecheck, tests, build; a look at desktop sizes, light and dark.*
2. *The docs it touches: roadmap, decisions, features; the step ticked in the handover.*
3. *`node scripts/version.ts "what this push is"`: the version and the changelog line.*
4. *Commit as sanchour; rebase onto origin's main (other accounts push all the time).*
5. *Tag the version; push main and the tag; check the deploy went live.*

The order of the versions

0.5.2-*alpha*.N	Lingua 5.2 being built; 0.5.2 at its check
0.6.0-*alpha*.N	Lingua 6 · Features, next (your answer); 0.6.0 at its check
0.7.0-*alpha*.N	Lingua 7 · Design, after it
1.0.0	The first public release, when you say so

CHAPTER 46

How Lingua is built

A web app that installs on the desktop and works offline. Everything runs on the learner's computer; the website only hands out the app and its language packs.

Vite 8 · React 19 · TypeScript · Tailwind 4 · Dexie on IndexedDB · Zustand · motion/react · Web Workers

app/	the shells, the router, the first start
features/	one folder per room
design/	tokens, motion, fonts, the primitives
state/	short-lived state, never the source of truth
services/	side effects: storage, packs, translation, AI, transcription, audio
data/	the database, settings, backups
core/	plain TypeScript, tested: text, languages, scheduling, diff, stats
workers/	heavy work off the main thread

Dependencies point downward only, and rooms never touch the tables directly. A tapped word is answered from the device in about a millisecond; only a word the pack doesn't know goes online, and is kept once found.

READ MORE

`docs/ARCHITECTURE.md`; the sixty-frames rules in `docs/PERFORMANCE.md`.

WHAT GOES ONLINE

Packs from the site; misses through MyMemory and Lingva; AI with the learner's key; the media services Lingua names.

CHAPTER 47

Keeping learners' data safe

Everything a learner has done lives in their browser. Losing it would be the worst bug Lingua could have.

NOW

Dexie version 17, `src/data/db.ts`.

The database changes only by a new version with its migration, never by editing an old one; each is tried on a copy of real data first.

WHERE

`data/backup.ts`, the merge in `core/backup/merge.ts`, both tested.

Backups are files the learner makes and keeps. Restoring merges or replaces; the newest change wins row by row, deletions travel along, and keys stay out unless asked.

Devices sync directly once paired, with no server between them.

The browser is asked to keep it: persistent storage is requested after the first start, so the data isn't cleared to save space.

Deleting is said plainly: removing a language names everything that goes with it; Reset says what it deletes; both ask first.

BEFORE A DATA CHANGE SHIPS

Make a backup, change, restore it, merge it: by hand once, and in the tests.

Never a migration that deletes without a backup step; never learning data sent anywhere to be stored.

CHAPTER 48

When something breaks

Calmly, in this order: protect the learners' data, stop the harm, tell people, then fix it properly.

How bad is it?

1. **Data lost or at risk.** *Everything else waits.*
2. **Can't study:** *the app won't open, a room crashes.*
3. **Wrong language:** *a wrong meaning, a wrong rule.*
4. **Money:** *a payment or a licence that doesn't work.*
5. **Looks wrong.**

What to do

1. *Revert the push that broke it (`git revert`, a version, push). Installed apps take the fixed version at their next quiet moment.*
2. *If data is at risk, ask learners to make a backup first: a line on the website and in a letter.*
3. *Find the cause with Settings › Lab (its reports carry the version) and the tests.*
4. *Fix, check, push. Write what happened and why in DECISIONS.md, and a line in the changelog.*
5. *Thank the people who wrote in, by name.*

NOTE

A revert is a push like any other: it gets a version.

CHAPTER 49

Working with Claude

START HERE

`CLAUDE.md`, then `docs/HANDOVER.md`.

Lingua is built across several accounts and computers. Memory doesn't travel; the repository does. Everything a session needs is written down there.

CLAUDE.md	The way of working and the rules that always hold
HANDOVER.md	The queue in order, how to claim a step, the prompt to paste
The plans	Lingua 5.1, 5.2, 6 and 7, each step planned before it's built
DECISIONS.md	Why things are the way they are
This book	How every page should look, read and feel
Design notes	Settings › Lab: pin notes to anything on screen, then paste them into a session

The prompt to paste, on any account

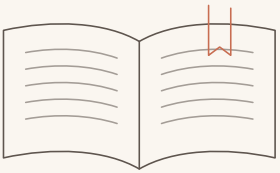
```
Continue Lingua. Read CLAUDE.md and docs/HANDOVER.md, take the first free step in
the queue (claim it first), and do it the way CLAUDE.md describes: plan it, build
it, check it at desktop sizes, update the docs, commit and push to main, check the
deploy, and give me end notes.
```

Sessions never sign in to your accounts, create accounts, put a key in a URL, or touch anything outside the repository. Those are yours (Part Nine).

PART NINE

Start to finish

The whole road from here to a public Lingua and beyond, what only you can do, and the two checklists that matter most.



CHAPTER 50

The whole road

AS OF

27 October 2026, version 0.5.2-alpha.4.

Ten stations. The first three are behind you; the rest is in order, and some of it can run side by side.

1 · The first builds
Lingua 1 to 3: the reader, cards, rooms, twenty languages, Grammatica and alphabets.

2 · Lingua 4.0
Tiers and seventy languages, the full dictionary, comics, the end page.

3 · Lingua 5.1
Plans and Stripe in test mode, the first start, Home, the course, typing, natural voices. Version 0.5.1.

4 · Lingua 5.2
The rooms still open (Visio, Diarium, Sermo, Mundus, Grammatica's path, Ratio), then its check. Version 0.5.2.

5 · Lingua 6 · Features
Foundations first, then the skills, paths, more of the language, around the app. Version 0.6.0. Next, by your choice.

6 · Lingua 7 · Design
Room by room from your notes, starting with the first start, with this book as the guide. Version 0.7.0.

7 · Ready to sell
Your part, and it can run beside 5 and 6: the business, Stripe live, the licence server, a domain, the website, the legal texts, a support inbox (Part Eight).

8 · A private beta
Twenty to fifty learners, three weeks or more, the five questions (chapter "Listening to learners").

9 · Version 1.0
The public release and its launch week, when you say so.

10 · Growing
The monthly rhythm; what learners ask for; the open questions (sharing, phone apps) decided when the time is right.

A SUGGESTION TO WEIGH: the beta doesn't have to wait for all of Lingua 6. After its foundations and the skills (Parts A and B), Lingua is more than enough to hand to strangers, and their answers are the best guide to the order of everything after.

YOUR CALL

The order of 7, 6 and the beta is yours; the handover follows it.

CHAPTER 51

What only you can do

Sessions build, check and write; they never sign in, create accounts or decide for you. These are yours.

ACCOUNTS

- [ ] Stripe, with Stripe Tax and the EU's VAT one-stop shop
- [ ] Cloudflare, for the licence server (free tier)
- [ ] A domain for the website
- [ ] The Chrome Web Store, for the browser extension (5.2-4)
- [ ] Optional: the Microsoft Store, to list Lingua there

THE BUSINESS

- [ ] Register it where you live; a bank account; an accountant
- [ ] A trademark search for the name
- [ ] The privacy policy and terms of sale, read by someone who knows
- [ ] A support inbox, and the refund rule

DECISIONS STILL OPEN

- [ ] Sharing and community: files and links, or a server (Lingua 6, Q2)
- [ ] Phone apps and widgets: "can be", but when (Q6)
- [ ] The three "remove" notes read in Lingua 7's plan (its Q1–Q3)
- [ ] When the beta starts, and when 1.0 is

CHAPTER 52

Choosing what's next

There will always be more to build than time to build it. Six questions, in order, settle most choices.

1. *Does it protect what learners already have: their data, their trust?*
2. *Does it stop someone from studying?*
3. *Did several learners ask for it, in their own words?*
4. *Does it carry one word further: the same word in more places?*
5. *What is the smallest version still worth having?*
6. *Could it be described honestly on the website the day it ships?*

Keep four short lists in the roadmap: now, next, later, and not. "Not" matters most: it is where good ideas go so they stop asking.

When two things tie, choose the one a learner would notice tomorrow.

IDEAS

The Lingua 6 audit is an option library, not a to-do list. Only planned steps join the handover's queue.

CHAPTER 53

Your own rhythm

Lingua is made by one person. A book about everything would be missing a page without one for them.

- A steady week beats a heroic one: fixed hours to build, one to answer people, one to write.
- Stop at a pushed version, never in the middle of a change: the handover makes stopping safe, across usage limits and accounts.
- Keep a done list as well as a to-do list. The changelog is one; read it when the road feels long.
- Learn your own language in Lingua every day. The best tester is a learner.
- When you're away, Lingua keeps working without you; say so in the letter.
- When stuck, ship something small, or talk to one learner.



CHAPTER 54

Two checklists

BEFORE THE BETA

- [ ] Lingua 5's check passed (0.5.2)
- [ ] The first start works for a stranger, start to finish
- [ ] Backups and moving to a new computer tested
- [ ] "Report a problem" and an inbox that's read
- [ ] Known issues written down
- [ ] Free licences ready for the beta learners
- [ ] A short welcome letter and the five questions
- [ ] The privacy page says what Lingua sends where
- [ ] The credits page is complete

BEFORE 1.0

- [ ] The beta's stoppers fixed
- [ ] Stripe live: a real purchase and a refund tested
- [ ] The licence server live; test mode off by itself
- [ ] The website, plans, install and FAQ pages
- [ ] Terms, privacy, business details online
- [ ] The name checked; the domain live
- [ ] Every screen through the review sheet
- [ ] Launch week written down, day by day
- [ ] `version.ts --line 1.0.0` when you say so

And then: thank the people who helped, by name.



APPENDIX A

The numbers

Every value in one place, from `src/design/tokens.css`. The palettes change some of them; see `palettes.ts`.

TOKEN	PAPER	NOCTURNE	USED FOR
--bg	#faf6f0	#1f1c1a	the page
--surface	#efe7d9	#2b2724	cards, fields
--raised	#fffbf4	#35302c	things that float
--sunken	#e8dfcf	#191715	wells, tracks
--ink	#262220	#ebe0cc	text
--ink-soft	#5e554e	#bdb19f	second text, drawings
--ink-faint	#776c63	#918779	labels, hints
--line	#e1d6c4	#3b3532	hairlines
--line-strong	#cec0a9	#514944	field edges
--accent	#c86d51	#d49b54	the bookmark
--accent-text	#a5533b	#dba765	text in the accent
--sage	#6b8e78	#93b39e	known, done
--sage-text	#4f6f5b	#93b39e	text in sage
--inverse	#3b302a	#e8d8bb	toasts, tooltips
--on-inverse	#f8efe0	#2b231e	their text
--learning-bg	accent at 14%	accent at 17%	a word being learned
--scrim	ink at 28%	near-black at 45%	behind dialogs

Type

Serif	Literata Variable, Noto Serif Variable, Georgia	`--font-serif`
Sans	Plus Jakarta Sans Variable, Inter Variable, system-ui	`--font-sans`
Display	the language's heading face, else Literata	`--font-display`
Sizes	44 · 40 · 36 · 30 · 22 · 19 · 15 · 13.5 · 12.5 · 11.5 px	

Corners and light

Corners	8 · 12 · 16 (buttons by size, small panels) · 20 (side panels) · 24 (cards, dialogs, the map) · full (pills)
elev-1	0 1 2 ink/6%, 0 2 8 ink/5%
elev-2	0 2 6 ink/7%, 0 12 32 ink/10%
elev-3	0 8 24 ink/11%, 0 28 72 ink/17%

Motion

snappy	560 · 42 · mass 0.8	soft	320 · 34
sheet	400 · 40 · mass 0.9	gentle	200 · 28
fluid	210 · 26 · mass 1	fade	0.16 s, ease 0.2 0 0 1
page	y 8 → 0 on soft	full	y 18, scale 0.985, on fluid

Screens and keys

Check at	1280 · 1440 · 1366 × 768, light and dark
Rooms	Alt 1–8, in the sidebar's order
Cursus tabs	1–4
Contrast	4.5 : 1 for text; accent and sage text use their `-text` tokens

APPENDIX B

Words Lingua uses

Cursus	a course, a running. The course, grammar, alphabets, typing.
Codex	a bound book. Reading.
Thesaurus	a treasury. Your words and decks.
Ludus	a game, and a school. The games with your words.
Sonus et Visio	sound and sight. Listening and watching.
Mentis	of the mind. Mundus (the world: the guide), Sermo (talk), Diarium (a daily record).
Grammatica	grammar, in Cursus.
Ratio	a reckoning. Overview, Tabula (a writing tablet: the languages you speak), Iter (a journey).
Ordo	order. Settings' old name.
Paper, Nocturne	the light and the dark.
Palette, paper	a colour set for each light; a page colour for reading.
Language touch	a flavour: a heading face, an ornament, a lean of the accent.
Tiers	Core, Full, Beta, Basics, Experimental: how much Lingua has for a language.
Lingua+	everything, once, €24.99.
Max	the AI features, with your own key, €5.99 a month or €49.99 a year.
Next up	Home's list of one-click ways back in.
The word drawer	what opens when you tap a word.
The inbox	where words wait before they become cards (Lingua 6).
The word record	one record per word: the language's half and yours (6-1).
The learner's record	the evidence of what you know and where you slip (6-5).
Ask	the tutor, a button where the learning is (6-15).
Lingyu	the design package's temporary name; its catalogue fed Lingua 6.
A0 to C2	the levels; A0 is "starting out".

APPENDIX C

Lingua 6 and 6 at a glance

Lingua 6 · Features first, then Lingua 7 · Design (your answer, 26 October). Each step is planned in detail before it is built, and checked against this book.

PLANS

`docs/LINGUA-6-PLAN.md` (step 23), `docs/LINGUA-7-PLAN.md` (step 24); the queue in `HANDOVER.md`.

LINGUA 6	STEPS	WHERE IT STANDS
Audit	1,618 entries checked; the plan written	*done*
A	6-1 word record · 6-2 inbox and decks · 6-3 cards and memory · 6-4 exercise engine · 6-5 learner's record · 6-6 checked generation	*first*
B	6-7 grammar · 6-8 reading · 6-9 listening · 6-10 sounds · 6-11 speaking · 6-12 writing · 6-13 translating	*after A*
C	6-14 courses · 6-15 the tutor · 6-16 adaptive · 6-17 goals and progress · 6-18 exams	*after B*
D	6-19 culture and the interface in the language · 6-20 phrasebook, notebook, map · 6-21 games and projects · 6-22 dictionary tools · 6-23 each language's tools	*after A*
E	6-24 import and export · 6-25 accessibility and the desktop	*any time after A*
F	6-26 experiments · 6-27 together, and beyond the desk	*your word*
G	6-28 the check; version 0.6.0	*last*

LINGUA 7	WHAT	WHERE IT STANDS
7-0	This handbook (first edition; this second edition adds Parts Two and Six to Nine)	*done*
7-0b	Design notes in the Lab: click anything in Lingua, pin a note, copy them for Claude	*done*
7-1	The first start, quieter and shorter	*planned*
7-2 – 7-9	Home, Cursus, Codex, Thesaurus and Ludus, Sonus et Visio, Mentis, Ratio, Settings and the plans	*waits for your notes*
7-10	The states, everywhere	*waits for your notes*
7-11	The check; version 0.7.0	*last*

Your answers to Lingua 6's questions

Q1	Lingua 6 first, then Lingua 7
Q2	Sharing and community: still to be considered
Q3	No live voice conversation inside Lingua
Q4	Yes: the interface in the language you learn
Q5	Yes: streaks optional, stamps not points, reminders off by default
Q6	Phone apps and widgets: can be, not ruled out

PRINT

```
node scripts/handbook-pdf.ts
```

When a step changes a rule in this book, the book changes in the same commit. Then print it again.

AT THE BACK

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